

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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A series of reflections from the Song of Solomon and the love relationship between two betrothed persons – a Bridegroom and a Bride to be - **[Series One]**

Looking at some of the spiritual truths that we might glean from their love journey together.

OUR FOCUS: LOVE'S DISTRACTIONS and DISAPPOINTMENTS

ADDRESSING: THE BELIEVER'S ENCOUNTER WITH
PREOCCUPATION, INCONVENIENCE & SELF PRESERVATION
In the context of love relationship.

Preoccupation – is the state of being preoccupied.

Is a state of mind in which you think about something so much that you do not consider other things to be important.

Also involves fascination with self and self-preservation.

Inconvenience - is the state or fact of being troublesome or difficult with regard to one's personal requirements or comfort.

Self-preservation - the protection of oneself from harm or death, especially in regarded as a basic instinct in human beings.

in the context of a love relationship, it is about being able to protect one's boundaries and emotional well-being while meaningfully engaging with others.

FIRSTLY.

**For this woman it was her encounter with
PREOCCUPATION**

▼ **It was preoccupation with self that led to a lack of ready response to her lover.**

Song of Solomon 5:2-8 NKJV

Verse 2. I sleep, but my heart is awake; It is the voice of my beloved! He knocks, saying, "Open for me, my sister, my love, My dove, my perfect one; For my head is covered with dew, My locks with the drops of the night."

- He comes to her in the nighttime outside the door of her room and he knocks and calls appealing for her to open up to him and let him in.
- He describes her in beautiful endearing and loving terms - and appeals to her to "open up" to him.
- She recognizes her lover's voice and his knocking and his passionate appeal to her – "open for me – I want to come in"
- Her lover is also **shepherd** and as a good shepherd he has been out in the night bedding down the sheep for the night.

SHE FAILS TO RESPOND TO HIM QUICKLY

"Open for me, my sister, my love, My dove, my perfect one; NKJV

('Open to me, my darling, my lover, my lovely dove, TLB)

- She fails to respond to his voice or his knocking and appeal for her to allow him to come into her bedroom.

HOW OFTEN DO WE DO THE SAME?

- When God is trying to Get our attention and wants to tell us something. Or possibly desires to come into “our world” - of doubt, fear and those things matters that our heart and mind struggle with.
- * **PREOCCUPATION WITH SELF OR OTHER THINGS - DISTRACTS AND AFFECTS OUR SENSITIVENESS** TO HEAR AND RESPOND TO CHRIST'S APPEALS FOR US TO OPEN UP AND ALLOW HIM TO COME INTO OUR LIVES, for companionship, communion etc.
- * **SHE DOES RESPOND**, BUT ONLY AFTER SEEING SOME VISIBLE EVIDENCE OF HIS PRESENCE – E.G. HIS HAND REACHING THROUGH TO THE DOOR LATCH
4 My beloved put his hand By the latch of the door, And my heart yearned for him.
- It was only then that her emotions were stirred towards him, and she enthusiastically responded to him.
- This behavior is likened in how Thomas expressed himself when he said he would not believe until he saw.
John 20:24-25
24 Now Thomas (also known as Didymus), one of the Twelve, was not with the disciples when Jesus came. 25 So the other disciples told him, “We have seen the Lord!” But he said to them, “Unless I see the nail marks in his hands and put my finger where the nails were, and put my hand into his side, I will not believe.
- How often are we looking for visible evidence of his presence like miracles, signs, wonders etc but we fail to hear his knocking and voice of appeal?
- ▼ **PREOCCUPATION with things or self** affects our sensitiveness of hearing and responding to Christ's appeals.

SECONDLY.

it was her having to address the issue of **INCONVENIENCE**
▼ **Of personal inconvenience** in her relationship with her lover

- * **Her response** to her lover's appeal reveals that she saw it as one of inconvenience.
- * **Inconvenient** in relation to what she had already planned
3 I have taken off my robe; How can I put it on again? I have washed my feet; How can I defile them?
*3 I have taken off my robe, **must I** put it on again? I have washed my feet, **must I** soil them again?*
NIV
- In her response to her lover, **she questioned** the reasonableness and insistence of his appeal.
- She Said: I have put on my sleep clothes and washed my feet **how shall I get them dirty again.**
- **“I have washed off the dust and grime of today's service** and have put off my work clothes and retired for the night”.
- In affect she was thinking that IF it was at a more appropriate time I would love to respond to my lover's appeal, but not now.
- {not getting soiled & dirty again from serving / ministering to others}
- ▼ Ministering to people is sometimes difficult and “messy” in the sense that we are fully exposed to their broken and sorrowful lives and its tragedies.

THE QUESTION:

- ▼ **IS THERE SUCH TIME WHEN IT IS INCONVENIENT OR INAPPROPRIATE FOR LOVE TO BE EXPRESSED?**
- Love **should** be available for our **LOVER** at **ALL times** regardless of circumstances or location.
- Love is about the **impulses of the heart** and should not be governed by schedules or appointments.
- Love is to be always present for our lover - Jesus Christ

APPLICATION:

TO AS LOVERS OF CHRIST

- ▼ **WE WILL ALSO NEED TO ADEQUATELY AND APPROPRIATELY ADDRESS OUR ENCOUNTERS WITH PREOCCUPATION, INCONVENIENCE AND SELF PRESERVATION IN THE CONTEXT OF SERVING OUR LOVER.**
- ▼ **WILL OUR RESPONSE BE ONE READINESS OR HESITATION** because of areas of our lives that still need our lover's gentle attention?
- ▼ **OUR RELATIONSHIP TO OUR LOVER MUST FIRST BE VIEWED AS A PERSONAL ONE BEFORE** it is seen as a corporate one – i.e. a part of the Body of believers, i.e. the church
Amen – Ps Barry